



AND YOU DON'T SEEM TO UNDERSTAND
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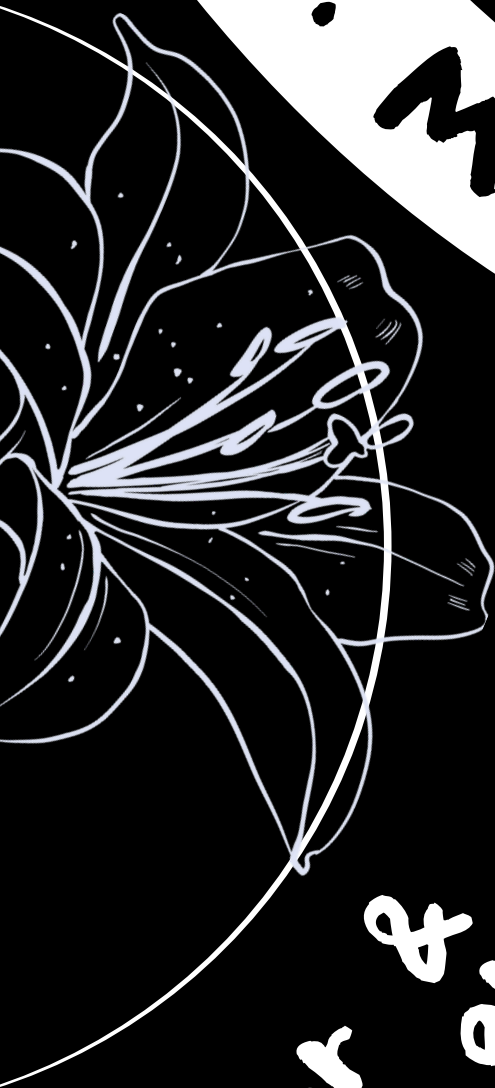
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The year was 1945, the second world war was almost on its end. And the world sees for the first time, the most powerful weapon of mankind, a weapon so destructive that it can erase a city in a matter of seconds. Families, animals, histories, all that once was full of life has been ceased by the power of technology. Nagasaki and Hiroshima were two important cities at the time, and as said by the us government, this cities has the perfect conditions for the test of this weapons, and in order to show their power, the us state promote such a terrorist act against citizens, no soldiers killed in this cities, just people living their ordinary lives. And since then, Japanese society has changed, this collective trauma influenced a lot, and still has its influence nowadays.



Art does not exist in void, it exists in a context, and in this context of trauma, these fears found their way to express themselves by the means of art. We could look at a lot of examples, but the most important for us to understand Serial Experiments Lain is the Japanese horror cinema in the late 90s to early 2000s.



Because of the trauma, the way that Japanese artists viewed technology was a terrifying one. Lots of movies made after the two bombs showed distorted bodies, bodies that were violated by the high technology, ghosts that spawned in computers and televisions, and people losing their life perspective. Another important event that impacted the cinema was the lost decades. It was a period of economic stagnation and a moment where many young adults didn't have any perspective of finding a job, and this context created many individuals without any kind of hope for the future, and only saw darkness waiting around the corner.



In this context a masterpiece called *Serial Experiments Lain* was brought to reality by the animation studio Triangle Staff (a curious name for me), directed by Ryūtarō Nakamura, written by Chiaki J. Konata. The series starts in a strange way, on the roof of a building where a mysterious girl jumps off. This start is stunning, uncomfortable, everything seems off, just like a nightmare, the colors, backgrounds, the entire scene get you in a nightmare. Right after the death of the mysterious girl, we see the protagonist Lain living her daily life, the eerie atmosphere makes everything look strange, as if this world is off.

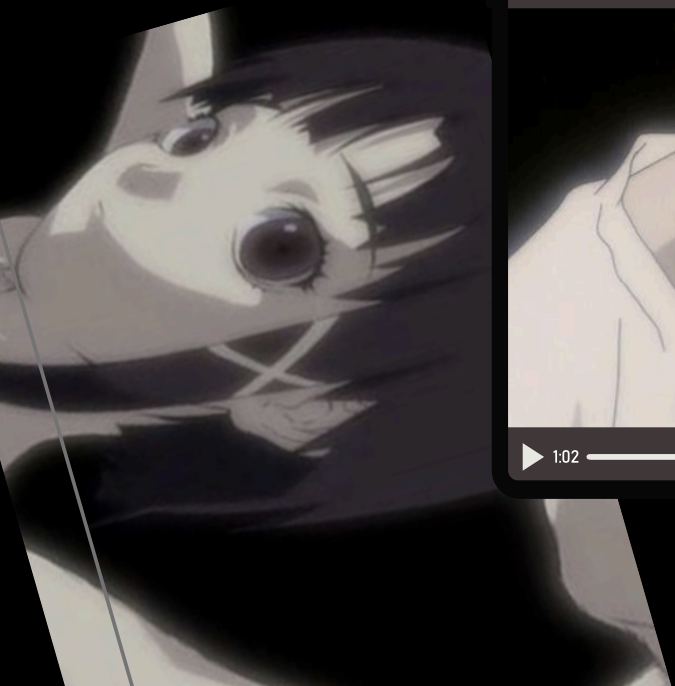
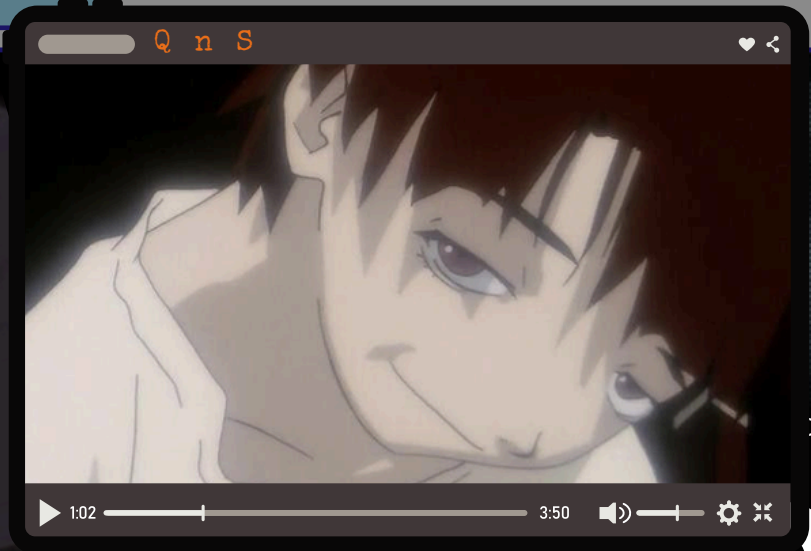
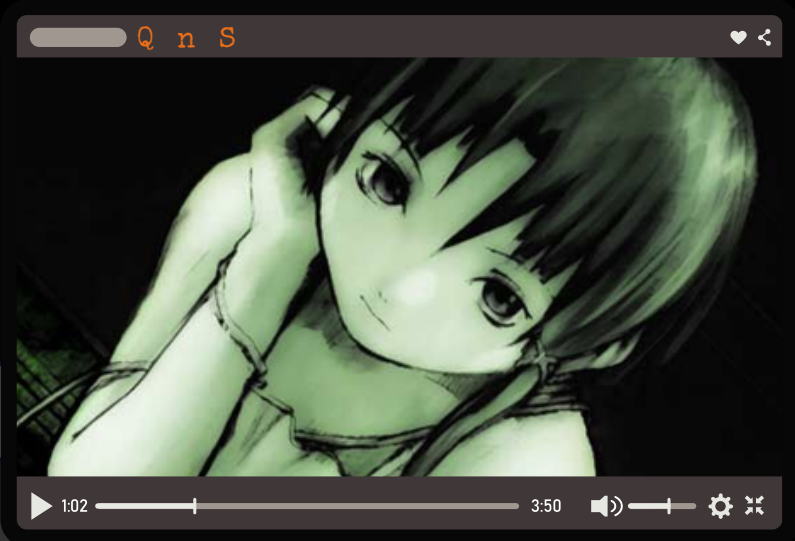


After the death of this girl that is revealed to be a friend of lain, lain looks up her phone and sees messages from her friend, which says that she isn't dead but alive without a body, on the internet. Nowadays we see a lot of people just living on the internet, without going out. This was such a terrifying prediction of the future, which sadly is getting worse. This anime gets really uneasy when you realize that many things came true, and that is such a masterpiece.

If you want a story that has a lot of mysteries and will get you to feel out of reality, this is the perfect anime for that.



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